

Ancient China

Beginning in 475 BCE, China was divided into several kingdoms, which were always at war with each other. This era, called the Warring States period, ended in 221 BCE, when the king of Qin conquered all his rivals. He ruled as China's First Emperor. Qin, pronounced "Chin," gave its name to all of China.

Kingdoms at war

The many warring states each battled to become the most powerful. They were eventually united into the huge empire of China.



The First Emperor

First Emperor of China

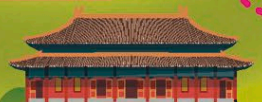
Ying Zheng, known as the First Emperor, ruled China harshly from 221–210 BCE. He forced everybody in the country to work for him. People had to build roads, canals, a great wall, and a huge tomb for him.



The First Emperor built a road 500 miles (800 km) long, from Xianyang to Mongolia.

The Straight Road

Xianyang



Epang palace

The capital of China was the city of Xianyang. The First Emperor built a palace here.

QIN



Chariot

Government officials traveled around in horse-drawn chariots.

Terra-cotta soldiers

Terra-cotta army

In 210 BCE, the First Emperor was buried beneath a human-made mountain. Nearby, an army of more than 7,000 life-size terra-cotta (clay) warriors was also buried.

